

Lesli D. Perez

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EDUCATION

The University of Texas Rio Grande Valley (UTRGV)

ABET Accredited

Master of Science in Computer Science - GPA: 3.70

2024 – 2025

B.S. in Computer Engineering, Minor in Asian Studies - GPA: 3.71

2019 – 2023

EXPERIENCE

Oak Ridge National Lab – ORISE

Knoxville, TN

Research Participant

June 2026 – End Date: December 2026

- Developing a Python CLI that interfaces with REST APIs to automate data parsing, processing, and retrieval.
- Executing quality assurance validation on five separate AI models to assess comparative performance.
- Developing a Unity AR application with real-time AI integration and controller/hand-based object interactions.
- Presented a poster to industry, academic, and national laboratory leaders at an internal research showcase.

UTRGV College of Engineering and Computer Science

Edinburg, TX

Research Assistant - MI@UTRGV

Sep 2023 – June 2024

- Analyzed AI and reinforcement learning algorithms to support innovative, data-driven projects.
- Developed and presented a [research proposal](#) on autonomous vehicles to CS professors and students.
- Implemented reinforcement learning experiments in Python to enhance recommender system performance.

Smart Technology Research Assistant - DoD I-DREAM4D Consortium

May 2021 – May 2022

- Researched multi-laser AM open systems and contributed to hardware selection and integration.
- Added features to legacy code in VS using C# and ActiveX for the machine's translation stages and galvo system.

System Analyst Support

Feb 2023 – Feb 2024, June 2024 – Dec 2025

- Automated user account creation using Bash scripts and first-login protocols, reducing manual processing by 90%.
- Installed and updated operating systems and software for university-managed computers.
- Upgraded systems from HDDs to SSDs, improving performance 2–5× and reducing downtime.

PROJECTS & ORGANIZATIONS

TikTok Users' Influence on Spotify Charts

Edinburg, TX

Data Scientist - Python, Pandas, Matplotlib, NumPy - ([Project Link](#))

April 2023 – May 2023

- Built ETL pipelines to extract streaming data from TikTok and Spotify using Python and Pandas.
- Analyzed trends to determine which platform influenced song popularity first, finding 66% of songs trended on TikTok before Spotify.
- Created visualizations to present insights on cross-platform influence and music promotion strategies.

Coffee Rating Predictor

Edinburg, TX

Data Scientist - Python, SciKit, Pandas, NLTK - ([Project Link](#))

April 2024 – May 2024

- Preprocessed 300 coffee reviews by removing null values, punctuation, stop words, duplicates, and encoding categorical variables.
- Visualized trends using word clouds and frequency analysis to differentiate positive vs. negative reviews.
- Built and evaluated a Gaussian Naive Bayes model to predict sentiment, achieving 83% accuracy.

Computer Science Resource Hub

Edinburg, TX

Volunteer Web Developer ([GitHub Link](#))

April 2026 – June 2026

- Developed and deployed a web-based resource hub to support programming and AI education.
- Researched and evaluated AI tools, coding exercises, and debugging activities for programming education.
- Built using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, VS Code, Git, GitHub, and GitHub Pages with AI-assisted development.

Tau Beta Pi Texas Nu - President, Social Media Manager, Member

Dec 2022 – Present

Rocket Launchers - Vice President, Telemetry Lead, Public Relations

Oct 2019 – May 2022

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Skills: Python (Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, NLTK), ML & Data Analysis, Front-End & Back-End Development. Exposure to: R and Ruby

Tools: Jupyter Notebook, Git/GitHub, React, Flutter, SQLite, Jira, Asana, Figma, Miro